

## Creative MegaWorks THX 5.1 550

The ultimate sound of music

With the MegaWorks, you're not watching a movie—you're bang in the middle of it! The THX 5.1 are manufactured with the expertise of Cambridge Soundworks—makers of high fidelity speaker systems with a Signal to Noise ratio of 99 dB. The revolu-



tionary BASH amplifier technology produces high power levels without sacrificing on the sound quality.

Setting up the speakers with the Audigy 2 Platinum soundcard from Creative simple because of the colour coding given for the connections to the individual channels. The acoustics are clear and loud enough for an out of the world experience. The bass is something that trance lovers will write home about. Turn down the bass and play a live orchestra track, and these same speakers produce the most soothing high-fidelity

sound that transports you to a live concert. Having the coveted THX certification, it is a great system for watching a movie with intensive sound effects.

The sound intensity can be adjusted by a fully functional remote control. The 150W RMS subwoofer overpowers the higher frequencies.

On the flip side, there are only analog inputs—there is no provision for connecting a digital input to the speakers. If you've got deep pockets, a large room and love music, don't miss out on this system.

### SPECIFICATIONS

5.1 speakers, 150 W RMS subwoofer, 5 x 70W RMS satellites, 25 Hz to 20 KHz frequency range, 99dB SNR, 14.3 x 10.8 x 16.0 satellite speakers (with stand), 30.5 x 29 x 32.5 cm sub woofer

**Bundled accessories:** USB cable, desktop stands for satellite speakers, monitor stand for centre satellite speaker, quick start guide, instruction manual, wired remote control

**Price:** Rs 27,999  
**Contact:** Creative technology Ltd  
**Phone:** 9820357713  
**Fax:** 022-26870860  
**E-mail:** rajshekhhar\_bhattacharya@cti.creative.com  
**Web site:** www.creative.com

| Creative MegaWorks THX 5.1 550 |        | A+ |
|--------------------------------|--------|----|
|                                |        |    |
| Performance                    | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Build quality                  | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Value for money                | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Features                       | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| OVERALL                        | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |

## LG L-112 IV Optical Mouse

This is no church mouse

The first LG mouse launched in India sports a low-profile design with a two-tone colour finish. The upper shell is made of a highly polished plastic, with a complementing orange transparent under-shell.



The mouse uses the standard PS/2 interface, with two buttons and a clickable scroll wheel. The buttons are large and well-placed within easy reach, but are very soft and lack good tactile feedback. This results in frequent dead clicks that makes the mouse totally use-

less as far as gaming is concerned. The rubberized clickable scroll wheel is smooth, but lacks that special touch that goes into great mice such as Logitech's MX500.

Priced at a Rs 1,000, plus taxes, this mouse is very expensive. Other mice offer

**Price:** Rs 1,000  
**Contact:** LG Electronics India Pvt Ltd  
**Phone:** 0118-2560900  
**Fax:** 0118-2560921  
**E-mail:** arastogi@lgezbuy.com  
**Web site:** www.lgindia.com

more in terms of ergonomics, precision and button quality at nearly the same price.

### SPECIFICATIONS

PS/2 interface, two buttons, one clickable scroll wheel and optical sensor

| LG L-112 IV Optical Mouse |        | B |
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| Performance               | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |   |
| Build quality             | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |   |
| Value for money           | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |   |
| Features                  | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |   |
| OVERALL                   | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |   |

## Samsung Combo Drive 48x24x48x16x

Jack of all trades

Samsung's new CD-RW/DVD combination drive is aimed at home users—for whom money and space are top priorities. It features 48x CD read and write speeds, 16x DVD read speed and 24x write speed for CD-RWs—the fastest speeds currently available for combo drives. It also has 8 MB buffer memory, which is a definite advantage.

The Dynamic Vibration Absorber (DVA) reduces vibrations in the drive. Bundled Software includes Nero 5.5, InCD and Cyberlink PowerDVD (an excellent application for reading DVDs). A sample DVD for demonstrating the drive's performance would also have been appreciated.

The drive performed noiselessly, thanks to its efficient damping system, and sailed through all the tests. One limitation was faced during the CD-R write test—Nero could write only at a maximum speed of 32x, although the medium claimed to be 48x-compatible. Also, even though the blank CD-RW

available for the test was 12x-compatible, Nero could write only at speeds of 10x. Thus, the times of the tests are equivalent to a 32 x 10 x 40 CD writer. However, it touched its claimed read speed of 48x in the Nero CD Speed test.



On paper, this drive offers the fastest speeds but, compatible media are not bundled or available in the market. The higher buffer memory and rewrite speeds don't seem worth the extra money and the only advantage is that it's future-proof—in other words, slightly ahead of its time.

### SPECIFICATIONS

128 MB capacity, Windows 98/SE/Me/2000/XP, USB power supply (4.5 V to 5.5 V), USB 1.0/1.1 interface, data retention of over 10 years, available in capacities ranging from 32 MB to 384 MB  
**System Requirements:** IBM PC or Notebook computer with USB port, Windows 98/Me/2000/XP

**Price:** Rs 10,000  
**Contact:** Samsung Electronics  
**Phone:** 011-51511234  
**Fax:** 022-56345859  
**E-mail:** marketing@samsungindia.com  
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| Samsung Combo Drive 48x24x48x16x |        | B+ |
|----------------------------------|--------|----|
|                                  |        |    |
| Performance                      | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Build Quality                    | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Value for money                  | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Features                         | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| OVERALL                          | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |